

WORKSHEET — PARASHAH KI TAVO

Appendix A (filled in) · The Frame for parashah study · a teaching tool

How to use this sheet

Work from top to bottom: first observe (A1), then weigh (A2), then diagnose (A3), and only then summarize (A4). The direction — received or grasped — is the horizon, not the starting point.

Basic details

→ First fill in the basics: which passage, which haftarah, any flanking reading with its status, and for whom you are making this.

Parashah / delimitation: Ki Tavo — Deuteronomy 26:1–29:9

Haftarah / ritual place: Isaiah 60:1–22 (sixth comfort sabbath; sheva de-nechemta)

Flanking reading and status: Matthew 4:13–24 — New Testament mirroring, confessionally used (not as peshat).

Target group and desired form: Study group / congregation · a compact study and a spoken reading.

A1. Text blocks and peshat

→ Read block by block. Note first what it says, then the key word or contrast, and only then a genuine open question — not steerable toward an answer you already want.

Text block	What does it say? (peshat)	Key words / contrast	Open question
26:1–11	When you come into the land, take the first of all the fruit in a basket, go to the chosen place, and speak the confession: 'a Syrian ready to perish was my father' (Egypt, exodus, land). 'Rejoice in every good thing.'	firstfruits · arami oved avi · rejoice · received → given back	Why does a story belong with the bringing of the fruit?
26:12–19	The third-year tithe for Levite, stranger, fatherless and widow ('I have hearkened'); and the mutual declaration: you have said the LORD is your God, the LORD has said you are His own people (am segulah).	I have hearkened · you / the LORD have said · am segulah	Who speaks first here — you, or God?
27:11–26	Gerizim and Ebal; twelve curses, mostly over hidden sins (the graven image in secret, misleading the blind), each answered with 'Amen'.	hidden sins · 'Amen' · wholeness (inside = outside)	Why curses precisely over what no one sees?
28 (hinge 28:47)	Blessing on obedience; the long, swelling curse on disobedience; and the key: 'because thou servedst not the LORD thy God with joyfulness and with gladness of heart, for the abundance of all things' (28:47).	blessing / curse · joyless service · 'for the abundance'	How can abundance become the root of the curse?
29:1–9 (hinge 29:4)	You have seen it all — the signs, the wonders, the forty	'no heart to perceive' · gift · 'unto this day'	If even the heart is given, what remains of 'achieving'?

Text block	What does it say? (peshat)	Key words / contrast	Open question
	years — 'yet the LORD hath not given you an heart to perceive, and eyes to see, and ears to hear, unto this day' (29:4).		
Isa. 60:1 / Matt. 4:16	'Arise, shine; for thy light is come' — the light rises upon you and the nations come to it. And: 'the people which sat in darkness saw great light' (citing Isa. 9).	received light reflected back · the eyes open	How does 'arise, shine' relate to 'no heart' in 29:4?

A2. Connecting hypotheses

→ Formulate two readings the text could carry, and choose with the test: which explains the most data with the least force?

Hypothesis 1 (one axis): the center of gravity is the Will axis alone — the parashah is covenant response: bring, confess, remember, obey, rejoice, answer 'Amen'. The gift side then stays background.

Hypothesis 2 (relation): the center of gravity is the relation between Source and Will — all is gift (down to the heart, 29:4), and precisely therefore the response is thankfulness, not achievement. The firstfruits embody receiving-and-giving-back in one act.

Which explains the most data with the least force? Hypothesis 2. Hypothesis 1 sees the response, but makes am segulah (26:18, God pronounces the status) and 29:4 (the heart is given) inexplicable. The relation reading binds the firstfruits, 28:47 and 29:4 into one figure.

What would refute this reading? If the firstfruits (front), 28:47 (mid-curse) and 29:4 (end) turned out not to be one coherent figure but loose rules, the center of gravity would lie elsewhere — for instance at the integrity of 27–28 (Coherence).

A3. Four axes

→ Fill in the text anchors and a short diagnosis per axis. Leave the last column for what your reading does not smooth over — the open anomaly.

Axis	Text anchors	Diagnosis	Open anomaly
Source	26:9–10 (land, fruit) · 26:18 (am segulah) · 29:4 (the heart)	Bearing. All is received — land, fruit, being a people, down to the heart to understand. The human receives before he brings anything back.	Why does God at times withhold the heart (29:4)?
Will	26:2 (bring the first) · 26:5–10 (confess) · 26:11 (rejoice) · 27:15–26 ('Amen')	Bearing — meets Source in thankfulness. Covenant response: bringing, confessing, remembering, obeying, rejoicing — as answer, not as source.	Where does 'thankful service' turn into 'my own strength' (28:47; cf. 8:17)?
Coherence	27:15–26 (hidden sins) · 28 (blessing/curse as consequences)	Supporting; honest as second pole. Wholeness — no gap between hidden and open; blessing/curse as a coherence of consequences.	Does 27–28 pull the center of gravity away from thankfulness, or serve it?
Trajectory	26:1 ('when you come into the land') · 29:5 (forty years) · 29:4 ('unto this day')	Thin. From exodus to land to 'this day' — pointing forward, not the core.	Is 'unto this day' a limit, or a promise still opening?

Reactivity: weak; not foregrounded ('I have not transgressed nor forgotten', 26:13, is response, not reaction). Note it as observation, and do not place it as the motor under the reading.

A4. Movement

→ Summarize the movement: what does the text unmask, what frame does it put in its place, what response follows — and capture it in one core sentence.

What is unmasked? The joyless, forgetful service 'for the abundance' (28:47) — the gift cut loose from the remembering of the Giver; 'my own strength has gotten me this' (cf. 8:17).

What frame does the text put in its place? Thankful remembrance: bring the first back with the story of grace on your lips (arami oved avi), and rejoice — because all is gift, down to the heart (29:4).

What concrete response and formation follow? Give the first back, not the leftover; remember the story of gift aloud; share with Levite, stranger, fatherless and widow; and seek the joy as a test — do I serve out of remembrance, or out of habit?

Core sentence: Bringing the first back — serving out of what you received; the joy is the test of whether you still remember Who gave it.

Horizon (not this week's theme, but the ground): beneath all this lies the one question — received or grasped. The firstfruits are the received-form; the 'my own strength' service the grasped-form. In the gospel the light rises (Isa. 60; Matt. 4:16) and the eyes 29:4 still withheld open in Yeshua — the given heart, embodied.